

# Direct Link Availability

For each platform: does yt-dlp hand back a media URL, how many, and can a browser download it as-is. Measured with `yt-dlp -g` (one line per media URL) plus a bare range request carrying no Referer or User-Agent, which is what a browser would send.

Date 27 Aug 2026  
yt-dlp 2026.08.19  
Selector bv\*[h≤360]+ba/b  
YouTube via --js-runtimes node

| 11 / 11<br>PROVIDE A URL<br>every platform returns something                   | 6<br>BROWSER-READY<br>usable with no server work | 5<br>NEED SERVER WORK<br>merge, manifest or headers | 4<br>LINKS EXPIRE<br>unsafe to store in history | 3<br>NOT TESTED<br>TikTok, X, Facebook                                               |                |                    |                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| PLATFORM                                                                       | PROVIDES URL?                                    | HOW MANY                                            | BROWSER-DOWNLOADABLE?                           | WHAT THE URLS ARE                                                                    | TYPE           | BARE GET / EXPIRES | NOTE                                                                                                                                         |
| GROUP A — ONE URL, A COMPLETE FILE. HAND STRAIGHT TO THE FRONTEND.             |                                                  |                                                     |                                                 |                                                                                      |                |                    |                                                                                                                                              |
| Archive.org                                                                    | YES                                              | 1                                                   | YES                                             | One complete video file                                                              | PROGRESSIVE    | 302 · never        | Redirects to the file. Sends <code>CORS: *</code> , so a blob download with a chosen filename works.                                         |
| Pinterest                                                                      | YES                                              | 1                                                   | YES                                             | One complete MP4                                                                     | PROGRESSIVE    | 206 · never        | Permanent link. No CORS header, so the filename cannot be set client-side.                                                                   |
| SoundCloud                                                                     | YES                                              | 1                                                   | YES                                             | One complete MP3                                                                     | PROGRESSIVE    | 206 · expires      | Sends <code>CORS: *</code> . Best case of all: blob download works, filename settable.                                                       |
| Streamable                                                                     | YES                                              | 1                                                   | YES                                             | One complete MP4                                                                     | PROGRESSIVE    | 206 · expires      | Signed URL. Use immediately; do not persist it.                                                                                              |
| Twitch                                                                         | YES                                              | 1                                                   | YES                                             | One complete clip file                                                               | PROGRESSIVE    | 206 · expires      | Served as <code>binary/octet-stream</code> , so the browser saves rather than plays it. Clips only; VODs untested.                           |
| GROUP B — SEVERAL COMPLETE FILES (A CAROUSEL POST, NOT STREAM PARTS)           |                                                  |                                                     |                                                 |                                                                                      |                |                    |                                                                                                                                              |
| Instagram                                                                      | YES                                              | 3                                                   | YES                                             | 3 separate videos from one carousel post — not video+audio parts                     | PROGRESSIVE    | 206 · never        | Each link is independently downloadable. The frontend must show three, not one.                                                              |
| GROUP C — TWO URLS: VIDEO AND AUDIO ARE SEPARATE. A BROWSER CANNOT MERGE THEM. |                                                  |                                                     |                                                 |                                                                                      |                |                    |                                                                                                                                              |
| YouTube                                                                        | YES                                              | 2                                                   | NO                                              | Video stream + audio stream                                                          | PROGRESSIVE    | 206 · never        | Both fetch fine individually but must be merged by ffmpeg. Needs a JS runtime even to resolve.                                               |
| Reddit                                                                         | YES                                              | 2                                                   | NO                                              | Video stream + audio stream                                                          | PROGRESSIVE    | 206 · never        | Sending only the first link yields silent video. Must merge server-side.                                                                     |
| BiliBili                                                                       | YES                                              | 2                                                   | NO                                              | Video stream + audio stream                                                          | PROGRESSIVE    | 403 · expires      | Worst case. Rejects any request without a Referer header, so the link is useless in a browser even before merging.                           |
| Vimeo                                                                          | YES                                              | 2                                                   | NO                                              | Two HLS manifests, video and audio                                                   | HLS MANIFEST   | 206 · never        | Both problems at once: manifests, and two of them. Resolves via the channel URL form; the plain <code>/&lt;id&gt;</code> form demands login. |
| 11 platforms tested                                                            | 11 YES                                           | 1–3 URLs                                            | 6 yes / 5 no                                    | 6 give a file a browser can take; 5 need ffmpeg, a manifest fetch, or custom headers | 9 prog / 2 HLS | 1×403 · 4 expire   |                                                                                                                                              |

| Platform                                                   | Provides URL? | How many | Browser-downloadable? | What the URLs are                                                                    | Type           | Bare GET / Expires | Note                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Group D – One URL, but it is a playlist rather than a file |               |          |                       |                                                                                      |                |                    |                                                                                                               |
| Dailymotion                                                | YES           | 1        | NO                    | An <code>.m3u8</code> playlist listing hundreds of segments                          | HLS MANIFEST   | 206 · never        | Counts as one URL but is not a video. Saving it yields a few KB of text. Segments must be fetched and joined. |
| 11 platforms tested                                        | 11 YES        | 1–3 URLs | 6 yes / 5 no          | 6 give a file a browser can take; 5 need ffmpeg, a manifest fetch, or custom headers | 9 prog / 2 HLS | 1×403 · 4 expire   |                                                                                                               |

**Reading this.** "Provides URL" is YES everywhere, so it is not the useful question — *Browser-downloadable* is. Two traps hide behind a URL count of one: Dailymotion returns a single URL that is a playlist, not a video, and four platforms return signed links that expire, making them unsafe to store in download history. Separately, only Archive.org and SoundCloud send `Access-Control-Allow-Origin`; without it the HTML `download` attribute is ignored for cross-origin links, so the browser plays the file instead of saving it under a chosen name. **TikTok, X / Twitter and Facebook are absent, not failed** — no test URL was available. Each platform was sampled with one URL, so results describe that URL rather than the whole platform.